



Ananya Ghosh Chowdhury

Swipe !!

CLOUD ENGINEER INTERVIEW

9 CLOUD CONCEPTS TO CRACK THE INTERVIEW

For Cloud Engineer interviews: the ideas
panels probe, explained the way you
should answer them.



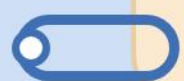
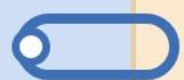
1.

Shared Model

The cloud provider secures the platform; you secure what you put on it.

- ✓ Provider: hardware, hypervisor, physical network
- ✓ You: data, identity, config, app code
- ✓ Line shifts left as you move IaaS -> PaaS -> SaaS

☐ In an interview, say: 'Security in the cloud is a partnership, and misconfiguration is usually on our side of the line.'





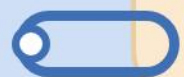
2.

IaaS/PaaS/SaaS

Three service tiers, three levels of control vs convenience.

- ✓ IaaS: VMs, disks, networks – you own the OS
- ✓ PaaS: managed runtime – you own the app
- ✓ SaaS: finished product – you own the data + users

☐ In an interview, say: 'I pick the highest tier that still meets the control and compliance need.'





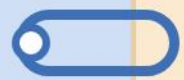
3.

Regions & AZs

Regions give you geography; availability zones give you fault isolation inside a region.

- ✓ Region = geographic location, latency + residency
- ✓ AZ = isolated datacenter within a region
- ✓ Multi-AZ for HA, multi-region for DR

☐ In an interview, say: 'Latency, data residency and blast radius drive my region and AZ choices.'





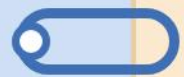
4.

Scale Up vs Out

Vertical adds power to one node; horizontal adds more nodes behind a balancer.

- ✓ Up: bigger VM, simple, single point of failure
- ✓ Out: more instances, resilient, needs stateless design
- ✓ Autoscale on CPU, queue depth or custom metrics

☐ In an interview, say: 'I default to scaling out - it's cheaper, more resilient, and cloud-native.'





5.

LB + Stateless

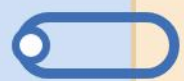
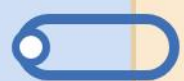
Load balancers only work when any request can hit any instance.

- ✓ L4 for TCP/UDP, L7 for HTTP routing and WAF
- ✓ Push state to cache, DB or object storage
- ✓ Health probes remove bad nodes automatically

☐ In an interview, say: 'Sticky sessions are a

☐ smell - I keep the app stateless and the

☐ state in a store.'





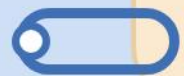
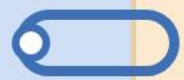
6.

IaC

Infrastructure defined in code, versioned in Git, applied by a pipeline.

- ✓ Terraform, Bicep, CloudFormation, Pulumi
- ✓ Declarative + idempotent, no click-ops
- ✓ Enables review, rollback and repeatable envs

☐ In an interview, say: 'If it isn't in Git,
☐ it doesn't exist - that's how I keep envs
☐ consistent.'





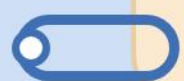
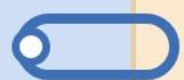
7.

VNets & Net

Virtual networks segment workloads and control what can talk to what.

- ✓ Subnets, route tables, NSGs / security groups
- ✓ Private endpoints keep PaaS off the public net
- ✓ Peering + VPN / ExpressRoute for hybrid

☐ In an interview, say: 'I design networks
☐ least-privilege first - default deny, open
☐ only what's needed.'





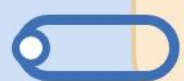
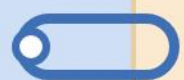
8.

Identity + ZT

In the cloud, identity is the new perimeter -
assume the network is hostile.

- ✓ Managed identities kill secrets in code
- ✓ RBAC + least privilege, scoped to resource
- ✓ Zero Trust: verify explicitly, assume breach

☐ In an interview, say: 'No stored keys -
☐ workloads authenticate as themselves via
☐ managed identity.'





9.

Obs + Cost

You can't operate or optimize what you can't see - logs, metrics, traces and spend.

- ✓ Metrics + logs + distributed tracing = the three pillars
- ✓ SLOs and alerts on user-visible symptoms
- ✓ Tag everything; right-size, autoscale, reserved capacity

☐ In an interview, say: 'Observability and FinOps are the same habit - measure, then decide.'

